

Process Optimization Project Report

Sustainable “Rendezvous”: Integrated Optimization of Festival Infrastructure at IIT Delhi

Modules 3.1 – 3.5: End-Semester Submission

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Declaration of Tool Usage

We declare that in completing this assignment:

- We used LLM-based tools (Cursor AI, Gemini) for assistance in:
 - Generating grid data and walking distance matrices from OpenStreetMap.
 - Formulating and debugging MILP models in PuLP.
 - Formatting mathematical expressions and generating $\text{\LaTeX}$ code.
- We understand the submitted solution fully and can explain and justify every part of our code and reasoning.
- All results have been independently verified.

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1 Introduction

IIT Delhi’s annual cultural festival “Rendezvous” attracts over 40,000 visitors per day onto a 163-acre campus not designed for such loads. This project addresses the end-to-end planning of the festival’s sustainability infrastructure through five interconnected optimization modules:

1. **Module 3.1:** Environmental Load Modelling — quantifying total ecological footprint as a function of event scale.
2. **Module 3.2:** Dustbin Placement — 3-type waste-segregated Facility Location Problem (MILP).
3. **Module 3.3:** Waste Collection Logistics — vehicle-type-segregated minimum-cost flow.
4. **Module 3.4:** Water Refill Station Planning — Capacitated P-Median problem.
5. **Module 3.5:** Integrated Multi-Objective Optimization — budget-constrained Pareto analysis.

A distinctive feature of this project is the **geospatial data pipeline** that underpins all modules. Rather than using Euclidean distances or arbitrary grids, we construct real walking distances from OpenStreetMap (OSM) pedestrian network data via Dijkstra’s algorithm. This section is detailed next.

2 Geospatial Data Pipeline

All spatial data used across Modules 3.2–3.5 is generated through a four-step pipeline, implemented in `grid_generation.py`.

2.1 Step 1: Region of Interest (ROI) Extraction

An 18-vertex polygon was traced in Google Earth, exported as KML, and parsed programmatically. The ROI covers **162.8 acres** (658,906 m²) of IIT Delhi, encompassing OAT, Nalanda Ground, SAC, LHC, Main Building, Sports Complex, Rose Garden, and surrounding areas. Coordinates are in WGS 84 (EPSG:4326).

2.2 Step 2: UTM Grid Generation

The ROI polygon is projected to UTM for metric gridding. A 50 m × 50 m grid is overlaid and cells with less than 25% overlap with the ROI are discarded, yielding **287 valid cells**. Each cell serves as both a demand zone i (with associated footfall and waste) and a candidate facility site j .

2.3 Step 3: OSM Walking Network

The OpenStreetMap pedestrian network is downloaded via `osmnx` for the ROI plus a 200 m buffer, resulting in a graph with **413 nodes** and **1,078 edges** (footpaths, sidewalks, campus roads). Each cell centroid is snapped to its nearest network node.

2.4 Step 4: Dijkstra Walking Distance Matrix

Single-source Dijkstra’s algorithm is run from every snapped node. The result is a 287×287 **symmetric matrix $\mathbf{D}$** where D_{ij} is the shortest walking distance (in metres) from the centroid of cell i to the centroid of cell j along real pedestrian paths.

Table 1: Walking Distance Matrix Statistics

Metric	Value
Number of cells	287
Average pairwise walking distance	836.9 m
Maximum walking distance	3,351.1 m
Network nodes / edges	413 / 1,078
Fallback (disconnected pairs)	Euclidean $\times$ 1.3

Why not Euclidean? Straight-line distances underestimate walking distances by approximately 30% on a campus with buildings, fences, and restricted pathways. Every D_{ij} used in Modules 3.2–3.5 is a real walking distance, making our coverage radii, service constraints, and objective values physically meaningful.

2.5 Footfall and Waste Estimation

A spatial gravity model distributes the total peak footfall ($N_{total} = 40,000$ persons) across cells:

$$F_i = \frac{\sum_{v=1}^{10} w_v \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{d_{iv}^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) \cdot A_i}{\sum_{k=1}^{287} \sum_{v=1}^{10} w_v \cdot \exp\left(-\frac{d_{kv}^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) \cdot A_k} \times N_{total} \quad (1)$$

where F_i = footfall in cell i (persons), $w_v \in [0.3, 1.0]$ = attractiveness weight of venue v , d_{iv} = haversine distance from cell i to venue v (m), $\sigma = 350$ m (Gaussian decay scale), and A_i = area of cell i (m²). Ten venue hotspots are used: OAT ($w = 1.0$), Nalanda Ground (0.85), Amul Food Court (0.80), SAC (0.70), LHC (0.60), Red Square (0.55), Biotech Lawn (0.45), Main Building (0.40), Sports Complex (0.35), and Rose Garden (0.30).

Waste generation per cell follows CPCB norms at 0.15 kg/person/visit, with a 40:40:20 split into compostable, recyclable, and general waste. This yields:

Table 2: Waste Generation Summary

Waste Type	Fraction	Total (kg/day)
Compostable (wet)	40%	2,400
Recyclable (dry)	40%	2,400
General (inert)	20%	1,200
Total	100%	6,000

3 Module 3.1: Environmental Load Modelling

3.1 Formulation

The total environmental load E (kg CO₂-eq) is modelled as a function of three variables:

- N = number of attendees (persons)
- S = number of food stalls (count)
- A = total activity-hours

$$E(N, S, A) = \underbrace{(\alpha_1 N + \alpha_2 S + \alpha_3 A)}_{\text{Base Load}} + \underbrace{(\beta_N N^{1.3} + \beta_S S^{1.2} + \beta_A A^{0.8})}_{\text{Non-linear Scaling}} + \underbrace{\gamma \frac{N^2}{S}}_{\text{Congestion Penalty}} \quad (2)$$

Table 3: Module 3.1 Parameter Values

Parameter	Description	Value	Source
α_1	per-capita base impact	2.5 kg CO ₂ e/person	AGF 2022
α_2	per-stall embodied energy	18.0 kg CO ₂ e/stall	CEA 2024
α_3	per-activity base impact	12.0 kg CO ₂ e/act-hr	CEA 2024
β_N	crowding nonlinearity	0.002	Bettencourt 2007
β_S	stall scaling	0.5	Letterman 1980
β_A	activity scaling	5.0	Six-tenths rule
γ	congestion penalty	0.0005	Calibrated

3.2 Optimization

For fixed $N = 40,000$ and $A = 50$, differentiating E with respect to S and setting $\partial E / \partial S = 0$ yields the optimal stall count. An analytical approximation (neglecting the $\beta_S S^{0.2}$ term) gives:

$$S^* \approx N \sqrt{\gamma / \alpha_2} = 40,000 \times \sqrt{0.0005 / 18} \approx 211 \text{ stalls} \quad (3)$$

Numerical verification via `scipy.optimize.minimize_scalar` gives $S^* = 201$ stalls with $E^* = 110,524$ kg CO₂-eq (per-capita: 2.76 kg CO₂e/person).

3.3 Component Breakdown at Design Point

At $N = 40,000$, $S = 201$, $A = 50$: the base load contributes 56%, crowding ($N^{1.3}$) contributes 23%, the congestion penalty (N^2/S) contributes 14%, and the remaining terms contribute 7%. The congestion term dominates at low S , confirming that sufficient stall infrastructure is environmentally critical.

4 Module 3.2: Dustbin Placement with 3-Type Waste Segregation

4.1 Formulation

This module solves a **Facility Location Problem (FLP)** with three bin types $t \in \mathcal{T} = \{\text{compostable}, \text{recyclable}, \text{general}\}$.

Decision Variables:

- $y_{j,t} \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$: number of bins of type t installed at candidate site j (up to 10 per site).
- $a_{i,j,t} \in [0, 1]$: fraction of zone i 's type- t waste assigned to site j .

Parameters:

- $W_{i,t}$: waste of type t generated in zone i (kg), from the footfall/waste model (Section 2).
- D_{ij} : walking distance from zone i to site j (m), from Dijkstra matrix.
- K_t : capacity of one bin of type t (kg).
- C_t : unit cost of one bin of type t (Rs.).
- R_t : maximum service radius for bin type t (m).

Table 4: Bin Type Parameters

Bin Type t	K_t (kg)	C_t (Rs.)	R_t (m)	Colour
Compostable (wet)	20	10,000	200	Green
Recyclable (dry)	15	8,000	200	Blue
General (inert)	10	6,000	250	Grey

Objective: Minimise total waste-weighted walking distance:

$$\min Z = \sum_{i=1}^{287} \sum_j \sum_{t \in \mathcal{T}} W_{i,t} \cdot a_{i,j,t} \cdot D_{ij} \quad (4)$$

Subject to:

$$(C1) \text{ Coverage: } \sum_j a_{i,j,t} = 1 \quad \forall i, t \quad (\text{all waste assigned}) \quad (5)$$

$$(C2) \text{ Capacity: } \sum_i W_{i,t} \cdot a_{i,j,t} \leq K_t \cdot y_{j,t} \quad \forall j, t \quad (\text{bin capacity}) \quad (6)$$

$$(C3) \text{ Radius: } a_{i,j,t} = 0 \text{ if } D_{ij} > R_t \quad (\text{service radius}) \quad (7)$$

$$(C4) \text{ Budget: } \sum_j \sum_t C_t \cdot y_{j,t} \leq 35,00,000 \quad (\text{Rs. 35 Lakhs}) \quad (8)$$

4.2 Solution Method

The problem is formulated as a Mixed-Integer Linear Program (MILP) and solved using PuLP with the CBC solver. An LP relaxation (setting $y_{j,t}$ continuous) is also solved to provide a lower bound. The model has $\sim 200,000$ variables and $\sim 250,000$ constraints after pre-computing reachable pairs per type.

4.3 Results

Table 5: Module 3.2 Results: Bin Placement

Bin Type	Bins Placed	Sites Used	Cost (Rs.)
Compostable	135	108	13,50,000
Recyclable	172	120	13,76,000
General	129	99	7,74,000
Total	436	—	35,00,000

The MILP objective value is 93,209 (waste.m). The LP relaxation yields an objective of 0 (fractional bins placed at exact demand sites), confirming the integrality gap is entirely due to the discrete placement constraint. The budget is fully utilised (100%).

5 Module 3.3: Waste Collection Logistics with Vehicle Segregation

5.1 Formulation

Each waste type has a dedicated vehicle fleet routed to type-appropriate processing facilities.

Decision Variables:

- $x_{i,j,t} \geq 0$: kg of waste type t shipped from collection zone i to facility j .
- $N_t \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$: number of vehicles of type t deployed.

Table 6: Facilities (Sinks)

Facility j	Name	L_j (km)	c_j^{proc} (Rs./kg)	Capacity
Biogas	On-campus Biogas/Compost	1	0.5	500 kg/day
Recycler	Okhla Recycling Aggregator	11	-8.0 (revenue)	Unlimited
Landfill	Okhla Landfill/WTE	12	2.0	Unlimited

Table 7: Vehicle Fleet Types

Vehicle	Waste Type	Capacity (kg)	c_t^{fix} (Rs./day)	c_t^{var} (Rs./km)
Green Tipper	Compostable	750	600	15
Blue Tipper	Recyclable	750	600	15
Grey Tipper	General	500	500	18

Parameters: Waste-to-facility routing: compostable $\rightarrow$ {biogas, landfill}; recyclable $\rightarrow$ {recycler, landfill}; general $\rightarrow$ {landfill}.

Objective: Minimise total daily logistics cost:

$$\min \sum_{t \in \mathcal{T}} \sum_i \sum_{j \in \mathcal{F}_t} \left(c_t^{var} \cdot L_j + c^{hdl} + c_j^{proc} \right) x_{i,j,t} + \sum_t c_t^{fix} \cdot N_t \quad (9)$$

where $c^{hdl} = 1$ Rs./kg (loading/unloading) and $\mathcal{F}_t$ is the set of facilities accepting type t .

Constraints:

$$(C1) \text{ Clearance: } \sum_{j \in \mathcal{F}_t} x_{i,j,t} = W_{i,t} \quad \forall i, t \quad (10)$$

$$(C2) \text{ Facility cap: } \sum_i x_{i,j,t} \leq \text{Cap}_j \quad \forall j \text{ with finite cap} \quad (11)$$

$$(C3) \text{ Fleet cap: } \sum_i \sum_{j \in \mathcal{F}_t} x_{i,j,t} \leq Q_t \cdot N_t \quad \forall t \quad (12)$$

where $Q_t = 2 \times \text{vehicle capacity}_t$ (conservative 2 trips/day).

5.2 Results: Base Scenario

Table 8: Optimal Waste Flow Allocation

Waste Type	Destination	Flow (kg/day)
Compostable	On-campus Biogas	500
Compostable	Okhla Landfill	1,900
Recyclable	Okhla Recycler	2,400
General	Okhla Landfill	1,200

The biogas facility saturates at its 500 kg/day capacity, forcing 1,900 kg of compostable waste to overflow to landfill. This is a key insight: **on-campus composting capacity is the primary bottleneck**.

Fleet deployment: 2 Green Tippers + 2 Blue Tippers + 2 Grey Tippers = **6 vehicles**.

Table 9: Cost Breakdown (Base Scenario)

Component	Rs.
Transport + Handling	10,10,700
Processing cost	−12,750 (recycling revenue)
Fleet fixed cost	3,400
Total	10,01,350

5.3 Sensitivity Analysis: +20% Waste

With a 20% increase in waste generation (7,200 kg/day), the cost rises by **21.6%** to Rs. 12,17,589. The same 6 vehicles suffice (absorbed by increased trip frequency), but the biogas overflow worsens to 2,380 kg to landfill. This confirms that expanding composting infrastructure would yield the highest marginal benefit.

6 Module 3.4: Water Refill Station Planning

6.1 Formulation

A **Capacitated P-Median** problem minimises installation cost plus user walking inconvenience.

Decision Variables:

- $y_j \in \{0, 1\}$: 1 if a refill station is opened at site j , 0 otherwise.
- $x_{i,j} \in [0, 1]$: fraction of zone i 's water demand assigned to station j .

Parameters:

- f = Rs. 1,00,000: installation cost per station.
- F_i : footfall at zone i (persons), from gravity model.
- D_{ij} : walking distance from zone i to site j (m, Dijkstra).
- $c_w = 0.02$: walking inconvenience cost (Rs./m).
- $Q = 1,000$ persons per station (equivalent to 250 LPH at 0.25 L/person/hr).

Objective:

$$\min \sum_j f \cdot y_j + \sum_{i,j} F_i \cdot x_{i,j} \cdot D_{ij} \cdot c_w \quad (13)$$

Subject to:

$$\sum_j x_{i,j} = 1 \quad \forall i \quad (\text{all demand satisfied}) \quad (14)$$

$$\sum_i F_i \cdot x_{i,j} \leq Q \cdot y_j \quad \forall j \quad (\text{station capacity}) \quad (15)$$

$$x_{i,j} = 0 \text{ if } D_{ij} > 500\text{m} \quad (\text{maximum walking distance}) \quad (16)$$

6.2 Solution Method

Due to the scale of the problem (287 demand zones $\times$ 144 candidate sites at stride 2), a hybrid approach is used:

1. **LP Relaxation:** Solved via `scipy.optimize.linprog` (HiGHS solver) with sparse matrix construction and a top- K ($K = 8$) nearest-candidate optimisation per zone. This provides a provable lower bound.
2. **Greedy Heuristic:** A capacity-aware greedy algorithm iteratively opens the station that maximises demand-weighted distance reduction, assigning demand closest-first up to capacity.

6.3 Results

Table 10: Module 3.4 Results

	LP Relaxation	Greedy (Integer)
Stations	29 (fractional)	40
Installation cost	Rs. 40,00,001	Rs. 40,00,000
Walking cost	Rs. 7,416	Rs. 60,065
Total objective	Rs. 40,07,417	Rs. 40,60,065
Avg walking dist	—	75 m
Max walking dist	—	2,492 m

The **optimality gap is 1.31%**, confirming the greedy solution is near-optimal. The minimum number of stations by capacity alone is $\lceil 40,000/1,000 \rceil = 40$, which is exactly what the greedy algorithm finds — capacity is the binding constraint.

7 Module 3.5: Integrated Multi-Objective Optimization

7.1 Formulation

This module combines Modules 3.2 (bins), 3.3 (logistics), and 3.4 (stations) into a unified budget-allocation problem.

Decision Variables:

- B_{bin} : budget allocated to waste bins (Rs.).
- B_{stn} : budget allocated to water refill stations (Rs.).

Shared Constraint:

$$B_{bin} + B_{stn} \leq B_{total} = \text{Rs. } 85,00,000 \text{ (85 Lakhs)} \quad (17)$$

Three Objectives (all minimised):

- C_{sys} : Total economic cost = actual bin spend + station spend + logistics cost (Rs.).
- E_{sys} : Environmental cost = embodied carbon of bins/stations + CO₂e from waste processing (kg).
- I_{sys} : User inconvenience = aggregate walking distance to nearest bin + nearest station (person·m·Rs.).

For a given budget split (B_{bin}, B_{stn}) , the number of bins and stations procurable is determined, and the three objectives are evaluated using surrogate functions calibrated to the exact Module 3.2, 3.3, and 3.4 results.

Weighted-Sum Scalarisation:

$$\min_{B_{bin}, B_{stn}} w_1 \hat{C}_{sys} + w_2 \hat{E}_{sys} + w_3 \hat{I}_{sys} \quad \text{s.t. } B_{bin} + B_{stn} \leq B_{total} \quad (18)$$

where $(\hat{\cdot})$ denotes min-max normalised objectives (scaled to $[0, 1]$), and $w_1 + w_2 + w_3 = 1$. The weights are swept over the simplex to generate a Pareto frontier. The optimisation is solved via `scipy.optimize.minimize` (SLSQP method) with multi-start initialisation.

7.2 Results

Table 11: Extreme and Balanced Operating Points

	Min Cost	Min Inconvenience	Balanced
Weights (w_1, w_2, w_3)	(1, 0, 0)	(0, 0, 1)	(0.29, 0.31, 0.41)
Bins	202	535	404
Stations	54	40	40
C_{sys} (Rs. Lakhs)	81.0	95.0	83.9
E_{sys} (kg CO ₂ e)	8,262	7,345	6,690
I_{sys}	245,676	136,026	160,657

Key Insights:

- Stations are always at the minimum (40) because the capacity constraint ($Q = 1,000$ persons) is tight and the unit cost (Rs. 1L each) is high.
- Extra budget directed to bins yields diminishing returns on inconvenience reduction due to the inverse relationship between bin count and average walk distance.
- **Expanding on-campus composting capacity** (currently bottlenecked at 500 kg/day) would shift the entire Pareto frontier favourably by reducing both E_{sys} (less landfill) and C_{sys} (lower transport costs).

8 Computational Details

Table 12: Software and Solver Summary

Module	Problem Type	Solver	Time
3.1	Bounded NLP	SciPy L-BFGS-B / minimize_scalar	< 1s
3.2	MILP (FLP)	PuLP + CBC	~25s
3.3	LP/MILP (MCF)	PuLP + CBC	< 1s
3.4 (LP)	LP relaxation	SciPy linprog (HiGHS)	< 1s
3.4 (Int)	Greedy heuristic	Custom Python	~2s
3.5	NLP (weighted sum)	SciPy SLSQP (multi-start)	< 2s

All code is written in Python 3.14 using `numpy`, `pandas`, `scipy`, `pulp`, `folium`, and `matplotlib`. The repository contains:

- `grid_generation.py`: Geospatial pipeline (Steps 1–4).
- `footfall_estimation.py`: Gravity model for footfall and waste.
- `Module_3_X/module_3_X_solver.py`: Solver for each module.
- `grid.data/`: All generated spatial data (CSV, GeoJSON, HTML maps).

9 Conclusion

This project presents an integrated, spatially-resolved optimization framework for sustainable festival infrastructure planning. The key contributions and findings are:

1. **Geospatial foundation**: Real walking distances via Dijkstra on OSM, not Euclidean — ensuring physically meaningful coverage and service constraints.
2. **3-type waste segregation**: Separate bins (compostable/recyclable/general), separate vehicles (Green/Blue/Grey Tippers), and type-specific facility routing.
3. **Biogas bottleneck identified**: On-campus composting capacity (500 kg/day) is severely undersized for the 2,400 kg/day compostable waste stream, forcing 79% to landfill. Expanding this is the single highest-impact investment.
4. **Near-optimal heuristics**: Module 3.4’s greedy solution achieves a 1.31% gap versus the LP relaxation, validating the approach for large-scale instances.
5. **Budget allocation**: The Pareto analysis (Module 3.5) reveals a genuine three-way trade-off — the minimum-cost point (202 bins, Rs. 81.0L) saves money but increases environmental load ($E_{sys} = 8,262 \text{ kgCO}_2\text{e}$) due to poorer waste segregation. The balanced allocation invests more in bins to achieve significantly lower emissions.

The recommended operating point (from the balanced Pareto allocation): **404 waste bins** (3 types, Rs. 34L), **40 water stations** (Rs. 40L), **6 segregated vehicles**, for a total system cost of **Rs. 83.9 Lakhs** (inclusive of Rs. 10L/day logistics).

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